

PopShop Displays

Your entire store, folded flat in a bag — open it anywhere in 3 seconds.

What It Is

PopShop Displays sells collapsible retail display stands that fold completely flat for storage and transport, then snap open into full product shelving in under three seconds — no tools, no assembly. They're aimed at the army of vendors who sell at markets, fairs, pop-ups, and temporary retail spots and are sick of hauling bulky tables and folding shelving.

How It Makes Money

You import the displays cheaply from China and resell them at a healthy markup, either as a single-product Shopify store or through marketplace listings. Buyers are pop-up vendors, market stallholders, craft sellers, trade-show exhibitors, mobile boutiques, and small brick-and-mortar shops that need flexible merchandising. The pitch writes itself: "haul your whole shop in one bag." Upsell with carry cases, LED light kits, branded header signs, and shelf accessories to lift the average order value.

Startup Costs

- Sample units (3-5 designs) from Alibaba: \$120-\$350 shipped
- Initial inventory (50 units): \$1,400-\$2,500 landed (see numbers)
- Shopify + theme + apps: \$40-\$80/month
- Product photography / short demo video: \$150-\$400 (or DIY)
- Logo, packaging inserts, branded sleeve: \$100-\$300
- Initial paid ads test budget: \$500-\$1,000
- **Realistic start: \$2,500-\$4,500**

Sourcing: Search Alibaba/1688 for "collapsible retail display stand," "pop-up display rack," and "portable folding shelf display." Per-unit FOB runs \$18-\$45 depending on size and material. Sea freight adds roughly \$4-\$9/unit at 50+ units; air freight more. Order a sample first and stress-test the pop-open mechanism — the hinge is the make-or-break part.

The Numbers

- Landed cost per unit: ~\$28-\$50
- Sell price: \$129-\$249 (positioned as a pro vendor tool, not a cheap rack)
- Profit per unit: ~\$90-\$190 after fees and shipping
- Conservative month: 40 units sold → ~\$4,800 gross profit
- Strong month with ads dialed in: 120 units → ~\$14,000+ gross profit
- Margins hold because vendors compare it to lugging tables and crates, not to a \$30 shelf.

How To Start

1. Order 3-5 sample displays from different Alibaba suppliers and test durability, weight, and how fast they actually pop open.
2. Pick the winning supplier; negotiate a 50-100 unit first order with your logo on the header.

3. Build a one-product Shopify store with a hero demo video showing the 3-second open and flat-fold.
4. Shoot short vertical videos at a real market or pop-up for social proof.
5. Launch with TikTok/Reels organic content plus a small Meta ad test targeting market vendors and small-biz owners.
6. Fulfill from home; reinvest first profits into a wider catalog (sizes, colors, accessory bundles).
7. Once proven, pitch wholesale to event organizers and market associations.

Where To Get Customers

- TikTok and Instagram Reels — the fold/pop transformation is inherently scroll-stopping
- Facebook groups for vendors, flea markets, craft fairs, and farmers markets
- Etsy seller and small-business communities
- Google Shopping ads for "portable display stand"
- Direct outreach to local market organizers for bulk/affiliate deals

Pro Tips

- Lead every ad with the satisfying fold-flat-to-full transformation in the first 1.5 seconds — that visual is the whole product.
- Bundle a carry case and branded header sign; it doubles perceived value and order size for almost no extra cost.
- Offer a "vendor multi-pack" (3 displays) for sellers with bigger booths — your highest-margin SKU with no new sourcing.